

Data Classification Policy

Langate Group

Purpose

This policy assists employees, contractors, and other third parties in understanding Langate Group's information labeling and handling guidelines, as implemented through Microsoft Purview sensitivity labels in Microsoft 365. It defines how data must be classified, labeled, and protected, and emphasizes practical steps to safeguard sensitive or confidential information (e.g., company confidential information must not be left unattended or shared without appropriate controls).

Scope

This policy applies to all information owned, managed, controlled, or maintained by Langate Group. Information covered includes, but is not limited to, data received, stored, processed, or transmitted via any means — electronic, hardcopy, or any other form — regardless of the media on which it resides.

Sensitivity labels are applied to:

- Microsoft Office documents
- Emails and attachments sent via Microsoft Outlook
- Files stored in SharePoint document libraries and Microsoft Teams channels
- Microsoft Teams workspaces (controlling collaboration and external access)

Roles and Responsibilities

- **ISMS Manager** is responsible for implementing and maintaining the policy.
- **Team Owners in Microsoft Teams** are responsible for ensuring that appropriate sensitivity labels are applied to their Teams and document libraries, and for adjusting labels when content sensitivity changes.
- **All Employees and Contractors** are responsible for applying correct sensitivity labels to files and emails, following handling controls, and reporting labeling issues to Team Owners or the ISMS Manager.

Definitions

- **Sensitivity Label.** A classification tag applied to a file, email, or Teams workspace in Microsoft 365 via Microsoft Purview to indicate its sensitivity level and enforce appropriate protection controls (e.g., encryption, access restrictions, visual markings).
- **Mandatory Labeling.** A configuration that requires users to apply a sensitivity label to files and emails. A default label is automatically applied if none has been assigned.
- **Label Downgrade:** Changing a sensitivity label to one of lower priority. A justification is required before downgrading any label.

Data Classification Scheme

Langate Group uses Microsoft Purview sensitivity labels to classify and protect data based on its level of sensitivity and the potential impact of unauthorized disclosure, alteration, or destruction. All data must be assigned one of the labels defined below.

Labels are applied to documents, emails, SharePoint libraries, and Microsoft Teams. They enforce encryption, access controls, and visual markings where required.

Sensitivity Labels for Documents, Emails, and SharePoint Libraries

The following labels are available for Office documents, PDF files, Outlook emails, and SharePoint document libraries. The table also defines the potential impact to Langate Group if data assigned to each sensitivity label is disclosed, altered, or destroyed without authorization:

Label Name	Priority	Description	Impact Level	Potential Impact of Loss
General	0 (low est)	Data not intended for open public access. Not encrypted. May be shared with external parties.	Minimal	No significant damage would occur. Information is non-sensitive and not restricted. Disclosure would have no meaningful impact on Langate Group's operations, reputation, or legal standing.
Confidential \ Internal and External	1	Confidential data that can be shared with trusted internal users and authorized external parties. No encryption. Access controlled by file permissions.	Moderate	Moderate damage could occur if shared beyond authorized external parties. Impact may include reputational harm, minor contractual issues, or unauthorized use of business information.
Confidential \ Internal and External under NDA	2	Confidential encrypted data shareable with internal users and external parties under NDA. External recipients must be directory guests or belong to a partner organization with federated access.	Significant	Significant damage could occur if shared without a valid NDA or beyond authorized parties. Impact may include breach of legal or contractual obligations, reputational damage, and exposure of individuals' information.
Confidential \ Internal Only	3	Confidential data that is encrypted. Restricted to users inside the	Moderate to	Significant damage could occur if disclosed outside the organization. Impact may include negatively affecting Langate Group's

Label Name	Priority	Description	Impact Level	Potential Impact of Loss
		organization. External sharing is not permitted.	Significant	competitive position, damaging the company's reputation, or violating contractual requirements.
Highly Confidential \ Restricted Access – Read Only	4	Highly confidential encrypted data. Accessible only by a limited internal group with read-only permissions. External sharing is not permitted.	Serious	Serious damage would occur if disclosed to unauthorized parties. Impact could include violating regulatory requirements, posing an identity theft risk, significantly damaging Langate Group's competitive position, and exposing the organization to legal liability.
Highly Confidential \ Restricted Access	5 (highest)	Highly confidential encrypted data. Accessible only by a limited group inside the organization. External sharing is not permitted.	Serious	Serious damage would occur if disclosed to unauthorized parties internally or externally. Impact could include violating regulatory requirements, posing an identity theft risk, significantly damaging Langate Group's competitive position, damaging the company's reputation, and violating contractual requirements.

Sensitivity Labels for Microsoft Teams

The following labels control access, sharing, and external collaboration settings for Microsoft Teams workspaces, Microsoft 365 Groups, and their associated SharePoint sites:

Label Name	Description
Internal and External	For general and confidential information that may be shared with trusted individuals outside the organization. NDA required when sharing confidential content.
Internal	For internal data only. Sharing and access are restricted to people within the organization. External sharing is not permitted.

The table below summarizes what each Teams label controls:

Category	Internal	Internal and External
Team Privacy	Private – users must be invited	Private – users must be invited
External users	Not allowed – no guest access	Guest access allowed
External sharing	Disabled – files cannot be shared outside	Files can be shared with trusted external individuals
SharePoint site access	Accessible only by users in the organization	Accessible for guests
Teams shared channels	Internal only – no external shared channels	Allowed for guests

Mandatory Labeling

Mandatory labeling is enforced by default across the organization. Users must apply a sensitivity label to all files added to SharePoint site or OneDrive. When a file is opened or saved without an existing label, a default label is automatically assigned based on its storage location:

Location	Default Sensitivity Label
Personal OneDrive	Confidential \ Internal and External
SharePoint library / Teams channel	Configured per library: Confidential \ Internal Only, Confidential \ Internal and External, Confidential \ Internal and External under NDA, or Highly Confidential \ Restricted Access

Once a sensitivity label is applied, it cannot be removed — only changed. Manually applied labels always take priority over automatically applied labels and will not be overwritten by automatic labeling policies.

Label Downgrade Justification

A policy requiring justification is enforced whenever a user changes a sensitivity label from a higher-priority label to a lower-priority label. Users will be prompted to provide a written reason for the downgrade before the change is applied. This requirement supports audit traceability and protects against accidental or unauthorized reduction of data protection.

How Sensitivity Labels Are Applied

Manual Application

Users can apply or change sensitivity labels manually in any Microsoft 365 application (Office for Windows/macOS/ iOS/Android, Outlook, Teams, and SharePoint). Users should assess the sensitivity of the content and select the most appropriate label.

Team Owners have permission to change labels on files stored in their Teams channels. Team Members cannot change labels set automatically or previously assigned manually — they must contact the Team Owner to request a change. Label modification permissions on SharePoint files are technically enforced — RMS Owner is automatically reassigned to a service account upon label assignment, ensuring that only users explicitly granted permissions can modify a sensitivity label regardless of file creation rights.

Automatic Application

Three automatic labeling methods are used to ensure consistent classification:

- Automatically labels all files in OneDrive.
- Default labels on SharePoint document libraries — configured per library by the Team Owner or ISMS Manager. Any file uploaded to a library without a label, or with a label of lower priority than the library default, will automatically receive the library's default label.
- Automatically labels all files in SharePoint sites — configured per library by the IT Manager.

Note on labeling timing:

- Files created or edited in Office for the web receive labels immediately.
- Files uploaded to SharePoint or edited via Microsoft 365 desktop apps may take a few minutes for the label to appear after saving.

For step-by-step instructions on how to apply, change, and manage sensitivity labels across Microsoft 365 applications, refer to the user guides available in Confluence:

- For Languate: [Getting Started with Sensitivity Labels](#)
- For CareBeller: [Sensitivity Labels User Guide](#)

Handling Controls per Sensitivity Label

The following table summarizes the required handling controls for each sensitivity label:

Handling Control	General	Confidential			Highly Confidential	
		Internal and External	Internal and External under NDA	Internal Only	Restricted – Read Only	Restricted Access
Encryption	No	No	Required	Required	Required	Required
External sharing	Allowed	Allowed (trusted parties)	Allowed (NDA required)	No	No	No
NDA required	No	No	Required	-	-	-

Handling Control	General	Confidential			Highly Confidential	
		Internal and External	Internal and External under NDA	Internal Only	Restricted – Read Only	Restricted Access
(external)						
Mandatory labeling	Default (local files)	Default (OneDrive)	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Label downgrade justification	-	Required	Required	Required	Required	Required
Visual content markings	No	Footer applied	Footer applied	Footer applied	Footer applied	Footer applied
Remote wipe (mobile)	No requirement	Recommended	Recommended	Recommended	Required	Required
Email forwarding	Allowed	Allowed	Restricted	Restricted	Restricted	Restricted

Additional controls applicable to all labels:

- Physical documents and hardcopy materials should be handled in line with their digital sensitivity classification equivalent.
- Confidential and Highly Confidential hardcopy materials must be clearly marked, stored securely, and destroyed by approved methods when no longer required.
- External sharing of Confidential \ Internal Only and Highly Confidential labeled content is technically

enforced by Data Loss Prevention (DLP) policies across Exchange, SharePoint, OneDrive, and Teams — attempts to share externally are automatically blocked and reported to the security team.

- Incidents involving the accidental disclosure, loss, or unauthorized access to any labeled data must be reported immediately to the ISMS Manager.

Assessing the Appropriate Sensitivity Label

When the correct label is not immediately obvious, consider the following questions:

- Who is the intended audience — internal only, or trusted external parties?
- Is an NDA or contractual obligation in place for external sharing?
- Does the data contain personal information (PII/PHI), financial records, or legally protected content?
- What is the potential impact if this data were disclosed, altered, or destroyed without authorization?

When in doubt, apply a higher-sensitivity label. Label downgrades can be requested with justification. If unsure, contact your Team Owner or the ISMS Manager.

Supported File Types

Sensitivity labels can be applied to the following file types on Windows, macOS, iOS, and Android:

- Word: .docx, .docm, .dotx, .dotm
- Excel: .xlsx, .xlsb, .xlsm, .xltx, .xltm
- PowerPoint: .pptx, .pptm, .potx, .potm, .ppsx, .ppsm
- PDF

Visual Content Markings

Visual markings are automatically applied when a sensitivity label is assigned to a document. A footer in the bottom-right corner of the document indicates the sensitivity label applied. These markings help users identify the classification of a document at a glance and are applied automatically — users should not modify or remove them.

Policy Compliance

Failure to comply with this policy may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment or contract. Non-compliance may also expose Langate Group to legal liability, regulatory penalties, or reputational damage.

The ISMS Manager will review this policy at least annually, or when significant changes to the Microsoft Purview configuration or applicable regulations occur, to ensure continued alignment with ISO/IEC 27001:2022 requirements.

Policy version history

 Policy details

Policy name	Renewal date
Data Classification Policy	April 14, 2027
Description	
The Data Classification Policy defines the high level objectives and implementation instructions for the company's data classification scheme.	

 Version history

Version 1					
Creation date	Approval date	Published date	Owner	Approver(s)	Publisher
June 7, 2024	April 17, 2025	April 17, 2025	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach
Version 1.1					
Creation date	Approval date	Published date	Owner	Approver(s)	Publisher
May 6, 2025	No approval required	May 6, 2025	Eugene Skubach	-	Eugene Skubach
Version 1.2					
Explanation of changes					
'Revision History' section has been removed					
Creation date	Approval date	Published date	Owner	Approver(s)	Publisher
September 26, 2025	No approval required	September 26, 2025	Eugene Skubach	-	Eugene Skubach
Version 1.3					

Creation date	Approval date	Published date	Owner	Approver(s)	Publisher
March 31, 2026	April 7, 2026	April 14, 2026	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach

Version 2

Explanation of changes

Added Sensitivity Labels

Creation date	Approval date	Published date	Owner	Approver(s)	Publisher
April 14, 2026	No approval required	-	Eugene Skubach	Eugene Skubach	-